

5.e) Practice Theory in Anthropology

Practice Theory in Anthropology tries to study anthropologically culture through social practices

Features of Theory →

- ① Studies cultural practices that happen in society.
- ② Based on those practices, it looks at social structure
- ③ Culture promotes practices which ensure harmony in social structure.
- ④ Practices causing social ills are avoided by society.

Significance:

- ① Provides understanding of how practices lead to social cohesion.
- ② Gives opportunity to understand emic view of understanding society in our cultural context

Challenges

- ① Synchronic studies have data manipulation (DM Lewis)
- ② Ahistoric
- ③ Difficult to replicate.

Practic theory enriches our understanding of culture studies and methods to study culture.